



2.12 Vehicle Recovery

1. Purpose

The purpose of the Standard Operating Procedure is to identify the hazards and define the steps in "Vehicle Recovery "

2. Scope

This procedure is intended for use for all Silverpoint employees .

3. Hazard Assessment & Identification

- Physical Stress
- Mental Stress
- Ergonomics
- Physical Injury
- Pinch Points
- Slips , Trips , Falls
- Bending , Lifting , Twisting
- Pushing , Pulling
- Equipment Damage
- Potential Energy
- Equipment Failure / Stress
- Weather
- Temperature Extremes
- Soft or Uneven Ground
- Other vehicles and People

4. EHS Requirements

- Fire retardant coveralls .
- Steel toed boots .
- Safety Glasses .



- Hard Hat.
- Rubber gloves.
- Hearing Protection

5. References

- Silverpoint Corporate Codes of Practice
- Alberta OH&S
- Silverpoint Task List
- Silverpoint THA 2.12
- Enform Vehicle Recovery Guideline
- Suncor Light Vehicle Recovery
- Cenovus /CLAWR Regulations and Rules

6. Procedure

6.1. Deploy Road Triangles & Hazard Lights

- 6.1.1. If the vehicle recovery takes place near a roadway, you must deploy a traffic warning or traffic control system (e.g., traffic cones or road flares).
- 6.1.2. To ensure the safest vehicle recovery area, all vehicles involved should use hazard lights and beacons if so equipped.
- 6.1.3. **When working at Foster Creek Cenovus, if you have a vehicle breakdown /accident, follow Cenovus /CLAWR regulations. This includes having your supervisor or Cenovus Rep contacting CLAWR. It is their rule that you freeze the scene till they have investigated and allow you to have the truck moved or towed. Failure to do so may result in suspension from the Cold Lake Airforce Base.**

***This applies to when you are off road on the ice roads, when radio calling is mandatory ***

6.2. Assess the Situation

- 6.2.1. Stop, consider the task at hand, and assess the hazards.
- 6.2.2. Complete a field level hazard assessment

6.3. Refer to Pre-job Checklist

- 6.3.1. Before you begin the vehicle recovery, you should refer to the pre-job vehicle recovery checklist.
- 6.3.2. Should you answer "no" to any of the questions, do not attempt the recovery on your own. A vehicle recovery



unit must be called .

6.3.3. **Never Use a Chain for Vehicle Recovery**

6.4. **Inspect Equipment**

- 6.4.1. While you are waiting for the recovery vehicle , inspect the equipment that you are going to use for the recovery (e.g., Recovery strap , tow hooks , shackle and your tow point).
- 6.4.2. Ensure that you have the correct equipment for the recovery . Your recovery strap should be at least 6 m or 20 ft. in length , with loops (not hooks) and in good working condition (no cuts or broken stitches).
- 6.4.3. Ensure the recovery strap has a Maximum Breaking Strength (MBS) that is 1.5 times the total weight of the stuck vehicle .
- 6.4.4. Ensure tow hooks , hitch receivers and any shackles used are rated to loads that exceed the recovery strap MBS . A shackle should have a Working Load Limit (WLL) stamped on it.

6.5. **Clear Debris**

- 6.5.1. To ensure the safest possible recovery , debris should be cleared from the recovery area . Do not to forget to clear the path for the recovery vehicle .
- 6.5.2. Clear out debris from around the tires , a shovel works best to clear mud , snow , sand or whatever may be obstructing the tire path in the direction of the pull .
- 6.5.3. You need to clear debris a least a strap length

6.6. **Conduct a Safety Meeting**

- 6.6.1. During the safety meeting ensure that you check both vehicle weights and add the weights of any loads either vehicle is carrying . Note that the vehicle doing the pulling must be of equal or, ideally , greater weight than the vehicle being pulled .
- 6.6.2. Discuss the means of communication that both drivers will be using , (e.g., hand signals or radio).
- 6.6.3. Discuss if the recovery will take place from the back or the front .
- 6.6.4. Are there any priorities that must be addressed ? (E.g., is there cement on the truck , do you first have to unload the truck before you attempt a recovery .
- 6.6.5. Survey the area , are there overhead power lines , underground pipelines , or cables to be aware of .
- 6.6.6. Will the recovery take place in a straight line or at an angle ? Remember if towing at an angle you need to be within 10 degrees of a straight line . Side towing can lead to serious vehicle damage and must be avoided at any cost .
- 6.6.7. Is the vehicle recovery safe to attempt with a minimum of vehicle damage .
- 6.6.8. Discuss the path of the recovery and the stopping point .



6.6.9. Is there a heavy coat or blanket to drape over the center of the recovery strap to use as a damper, in case of a backlash, snap or release?

6.6.10. Have both drivers sign off on the safety meeting before attempting the recovery.

6.7. Pull up into the best position for the recovery

6.7.1. After the safety meeting, have the driver of the recovery vehicle pull up into the best position for the recovery as discussed at the safety meeting.

6.7.2. After the recovery vehicle is in the desired position, complete a walk around of both vehicles to ensure the recovery will take place in the safest manner possible.

6.7.3. Ensure the recovery vehicle is completely stopped with park brakes engaged before you walk between the two vehicles.

6.8. Connect the recovery strap to both vehicles

6.8.1. Ensure the recovery strap will be connected correctly.

6.8.2. If using two straps, **NEVER USE A SHACKLE OR CLEVIS TO JOIN THE TWO STRAPS**. If a strap should snap or break, the shackle or clevis will become a missile with deadly consequences. Connect the two straps using the loop in the straps.

6.8.3. First connect the strap to the stuck vehicle using the tow point, (e.g., pintle hitch or the pin on the front bumper).

6.8.4. Always use a tow point rated for recovery. Never tie a strap to the frame or a bumper or any other point that will cause damage.

6.8.5. Now connect the recovery vehicle. If you must, have the driver of the recovery vehicle back up close enough to connect the recovery strap.

6.8.6. Always, if at all possible, connect to the back of the recovery vehicle. This way, the driver of the recovery vehicle is driving forward in the safest manner.

6.8.7. Drape a heavy coat or blanket over the middle of the strap to dampen any backlash if the strap snaps or breaks.

6.9. Ensure by-standers are out of the way

6.9.1. Ensure by-standers are out of the way and at least 1.5 times the length of the recovery strap to the side of the vehicles.

6.9.2. Speak clearly and loudly so that you are understood, as a vehicle recovery presents a hazard and may cause injury to a by-stander.

6.10. Safely begin towing the stuck vehicle

6.10.1. The recovery vehicle should now begin to accelerate slowly to build tension in the recovery strap and provide



a sustained pull.

6.10.2. Once the slack is taken up, the stuck vehicle should likewise apply acceleration in 2nd gear to assist the recovery vehicle.

6.10.3. Neither vehicle should spin the tires. Steady momentum is most effective. Never resort to jerking or backing up and taking a run at it.

6.10.4. Maintain tension throughout the pull. Do not allow slack in the recovery strap to develop at any point.

6.10.5. After three attempts to pull the vehicle loose, it is time to stop and call a tow truck.

6.11. When you are clear, Stop and remove strap

6.11.1. Once you are free, stop at the pre-designated area and remove the recovery strap.

6.11.2. First unhook the recovery vehicle. Then remove the recovery strap from the previously stuck vehicle.

6.12. Inspect Vehicles and Equipment for damage

6.12.1. Once the recovery has been completed, inspect all equipment used in the recovery, (e.g., recovery strap, shackle, tow point) for damage.

6.12.2. Both drivers should inspect their own vehicle for damage that may have occurred during the recovery.

6.12.3. If any damage has occurred, document the damage, and have the other driver sign off on it.

6.13. Complete Safety Meeting

6.13.1. Before both drivers leave the recovery site, the safety meeting should be completed stating that the recovery went well, or damage occurred during the recovery.

6.13.2. Ensure this is documented and signed off by both drivers involved.

Remember : if you are in doubt about what to do, call your Supervisor